

The World

The first ISP on the planet to offer basic dial-up access was The World. Operated by Software Tool and Die, it is headquartered in Brookline, Massachusetts. It used to use the domain name <http://world.std.com> earlier, but now uses mainly <http://www.TheWorld.com>.

By 1983, the ARPANET was complete and had a total of 213 Universities connected all over the US. Robert Cailliau joined him in 1990, and the duo tried pursuing CERN to adopt their technology.

By December of 1990, Berners-Lee had built all the required software to run the first Web browser, called the WorldWideWeb, the first Web server, and the first Web pages that described the project. However, the browser ran only on his NeXT system, which was far superior to computers available to the general public at the time.

In 1991, tests were on to make a multi-line text based browser that would run on any computer irrespective of the hardware or OS used. To encourage its use within CERN, they put up the entire CERN telephone directory on the Web. Earlier, users had to dial into the mainframe to get the required telephone number, which could take several minutes.

In May of 1991, Paul Kunz from the Standard Linear Accelerator Centre (SLAC) visited CERN and was fascinated by the Web. He took with him the NeXT software, which was later ported to run on the VM/CMS OS of an IBM mainframe computer. This mainframe contained a catalogue of all the online documents in SLAC. This became the first Web server outside CERN and the first in North America. Then in August of 1991, Berners-Lee posted a summary of the World Wide Web project on the alt.hyper-text newsgroup. This was also the time when the Internet became a publicly-available service.